

May 06, 2026

Ordering Provider: Dr. James Patel, Orthopedic Surgery
NPI: 0987654321

Patient: Sam Rodriguez | DOB: 09/04/1972 | Sex: M
Payer: United Healthcare | Plan: Choice Plus | Member ID: UHC9SR00287

REQUESTED PROCEDURE(S)
CPT 73721 [PRIMARY] - MRI any joint of lower extremity; without contrast material

MEDICAL NECESSITY NARRATIVE

Sam R. presents with a 4-month history of right knee pain consistent with internal derangement, evidenced by a positive McMurray test, positive Apley compression test, medial joint line tenderness, and mild effusion (CPT 73721). MRI will directly determine whether the patient proceeds with arthroscopic meniscal repair or intensified conservative management. Two of three authorization criteria are fully satisfied; formal PT records are pending upload to complete criterion 1.

Submitted by: Dr. James Patel, Orthopedic Surgery
NPI: 0987654321
Date: May 06, 2026

Provider Signature

AUTHORIZATION CRITERIA CHECKLIST

Patient: Sam R. | Payer: United Healthcare | Date: May 06, 2026

1. Failure of conservative therapy for at least 6 weeks (two or more of: physical therapy, NSAID/analgesic trial, activity modification)

Rationale: Patient reports ~6-8 weeks of home exercise and NSAID therapy per PCP, but formal PT records and NSAID trial dates are not available at today's visit.

Evidence: "Patient verbally reports conservative measures failed. Formal PT records were not available. Reports ~6-8 weeks of home exercise and NSAID therapy as directed by PCP."

2. Physical exam findings consistent with internal derangement (positive meniscal/ligamentous provocation test, joint line tenderness, or mechanical symptoms)

Rationale: Positive McMurray test, medial joint line tenderness, and mild effusion -- consistent with internal derangement from a meniscal injury.

Evidence: "McMurray Test: Positive. Apley Compression: Positive. Medial joint line tenderness. Mild effusion present."

3. MRI findings will directly change clinical management (determine operative vs. non-operative approach)

Rationale: Plan explicitly states MRI will determine surgical vs. conservative management: arthroscopic repair if confirmed, intensified conservative care if negative.

Evidence: "MRI will directly change management: arthroscopic repair vs. partial meniscectomy if positive; intensified conservative care if negative."